

Word family: **exhibit / exhibits / exhibited / exhibiting / exhibitor / exhibiter / exhibitory / exhibition**

This is the **full replacement entry for `exhibit`**. I've treated it separately from **exhibition** and done the broader noun–verb–legal–scientific–fixed-expression sweep before merging.

Base word: exhibit

Forms: exhibits, exhibited, exhibiting

Related forms: exhibitor, exhibiter, exhibitory, exhibition

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞)

A useful starting point is that modern dictionaries consistently recognize three major verb areas—**show publicly**, **manifest/show a quality**, and **legal presentation of evidence**—plus several noun uses: **an item displayed**, **an exhibition/show** (especially AmE), and **a legal exhibit**. ([美國遺產詞典][1])

1. **exhibit = deliberately show something for others to see (展示) — 展示 ; 出示 ; 呈現**

Meaning: To deliberately present something so that other people can see, inspect, or examine it.

Practice 1

> “He rolled up his sleeve to **exhibit** the scar.”

「他捲起袖子，把傷疤**展示 / 露給別人看**。」

Practice 2

> “The machine was **exhibited** for inspection.”

「那部機器被**展示出來供人檢查**。」

exhibit = 把某物呈現在別人面前，讓人觀看、檢視或注意

This is broader than museum exhibitions.

It includes:

- * showing something for inspection
- * presenting something visibly
- * making something available for people to examine

American Heritage explicitly distinguishes presenting something for others to see from the more

specific public-exhibition use. ([美國遺產詞典][1])

2. **exhibit** = display publicly in a museum, gallery, show, competition, etc. (公開展出) — 展出；陳列

This is the most familiar modern verb use.

Practice 3

> “The gallery is **exhibiting** several of her paintings.”

「畫廊正在**展出**她的幾幅畫作。」

Practice 4

> “The flowers were **exhibited** at the local show.”

「那些花在本地展覽中**展出**。」

exhibit something = 把藝術品、產品、動植物或其他物件公開展出，供觀賞、評審、教育或宣傳

Cambridge explicitly includes public showing for purposes such as competition, sale, or amusement. ([劍橋詞典][2])

For strict semantic counting, #1 and #2 belong to the same broad **make visible / present to view** branch, but #2 deserves explicit learner treatment because the collocations are so established.

3. **exhibit** = participate in an exhibition / show one's work publicly (不及物) — 參展；展出作品

This was one of the previously missed grammatical branches.

Exhibit can be **intransitive**.

Practice 5

> “She has **exhibited** in galleries around the world.”

「她曾在世界各地的畫廊**參展 / 展出作品**。」

Practice 6

> “Are you **exhibiting** at the trade show this year?”

「你今年會在那個商貿展覽會**參展**嗎？」

exhibit = 作為藝術家、公司、參展者等參與公開展覽

No direct object is required:

> She exhibits regularly.

Cambridge, Collins, and American Heritage all recognize this intransitive use. ([劍橋詞典][3])

For core semantic counting, this remains under the public-display branch, but grammatically it absolutely needs to be mapped.

4. **exhibit** = show a quality, feeling, behaviour, ability, symptom, property, etc. (顯示 / 表現)
— 表現出 ; 顯示 ; 呈現

This is a major abstract sense.

Practice 7

> “She **exhibited** remarkable patience.”

「她**表現出**非凡的耐性。」

Practice 8

> “The patient **exhibited** signs of infection.”

「病人**出現 / 顯示出**感染的跡象。」

Practice 9

> “The material **exhibits** unusual properties.”

「這種材料**呈現出**不尋常的特性。」

exhibit = 某人或某事物明顯顯示出某種特徵、行為、能力、症狀或性質

Common:

* exhibit symptoms

- * exhibit signs
- * exhibit behaviour
- * exhibit confidence
- * exhibit characteristics
- * exhibit properties
- * exhibit a tendency

Cambridge and Collins both treat this as a major modern sense; American Heritage also gives both outward-display and “give evidence of/demonstrate” formulations. ([劍橋詞典][4])

5. **exhibit = reveal evidence of something existing (證明 / 顯示存在) — 顯示 ; 證明具有**

There is a subtle extension of #4 worth understanding.

Sometimes the subject is not actively “showing” anything. Rather, it **possesses a property that becomes observable**.

Practice 10

> “The plant **exhibits** dimorphism.”

「這種植物**呈現**二型性。」

Practice 11

> “The samples **exhibited** similar patterns.”

「這些樣本**呈現出**相似模式。」

This is especially common in:

- * science
- * engineering
- * medicine
- * research writing

exhibit = 具有並可觀察到某種特性 / 現象

For database purposes, I would merge this with #4. The underlying concept is still:

> **make a characteristic observable / give evidence of it**

6. **exhibit** = formally present something in court as evidence (法律動詞) — 向法庭出示 / 提交證據

This is the legal verb branch that must be retained.

Practice 12

> “The document was **exhibited** to the court.”

「該文件被正式提交 / 出示給法庭作為證據。」

Practice 13

> “Counsel **exhibited** the photograph during the hearing.”

「律師在聆訊期間正式出示了該照片。」

exhibit = 在法律程序中正式提交、出示文件或實物，供識別或作為證據

Collins explicitly lists the legal verb as formally presenting a document or object to a court. ([Collins 字典][5])

This is institutionalized enough that I would **not** hide it inside generic “show.”

7. **an exhibit** = an individual object/item displayed publicly (名詞) — 展品

This is one of the main noun meanings.

Practice 14

> “The dinosaur skeleton is the museum’s most popular **exhibit**.”

「那副恐龍骨架是博物館最受歡迎的展品。」

Practice 15

> “Each **exhibit** includes a short description.”

「每件展品都有簡短說明。」

an exhibit = 在博物館、畫廊、展覽會等被公開展示的物件

Cambridge specifically defines this as an object shown publicly in a museum or similar setting. ([劍橋詞典][4])

8. ****an exhibit = a collection/display as a whole, especially AmE (美式) — 展覽；展區；整組展出內容****

This is another branch we previously failed to surface clearly enough.

Especially in American English:

> ****exhibit****

can mean the whole organized display, roughly equivalent to British-English ****exhibition****.

Practice 16

> “We went to see the new dinosaur ****exhibit****.”

「我們去看新的恐龍****展覽****。」

Practice 17

> “The museum has opened an ****exhibit**** on space exploration.”

「博物館開設了一個關於太空探索的****展覽****。」

So:

> ****an exhibit****

may mean:

1. one individual displayed item, ****or****
2. an organized collection/display.

Context decides.

Cambridge explicitly labels the whole-collection sense as US usage, while American Heritage defines ****exhibit**** as “a public showing; an exhibition.” ([劍橋詞典][4])

This is a genuinely important regional distinction.

9. ****exhibit = legal evidence formally identified in a proceeding (法律名詞) — 證物；證據材料****

This is a major distinct noun sense.

Practice 18

> “The photograph was marked as **Exhibit A**.”

「那張照片被標記為**證物 A**。」

Practice 19

> “The jury asked to see several of the **exhibits** again.”

「陪審團要求再次查看幾項**證物**。」

A legal **exhibit** can be:

- * a document
- * photograph
- * physical object
- * recording
- * diagram
- * animation
- * other evidentiary material

Cornell's Legal Information Institute defines an exhibit as material formally introduced as evidence in legal proceedings. ([法律信息研究所][6])

legal exhibit = 在法律程序中正式識別、提交或擬提交作為證據的材料

10. **exhibit = attachment to a contract, pleading, motion, affidavit, etc. (法律文件附件) — 附件 ; 附表**

This is another important legal branch that deserves explicit inclusion.

An **exhibit** does not only mean courtroom physical evidence.

It can also mean a document or material attached to a legal instrument.

Practice 20

> “See **Exhibit B** attached to the agreement.”

「請參閱協議所附的**附件 B**。」

Practice 21

> “The schedule is attached as an **exhibit** to the contract.”

「該附表作為合約的**附件**附上。」

Cornell specifically includes attachments to motions, contracts, pleadings, and other legal instruments in its definition of **exhibit**. ([法律信息研究所][6])

This is extremely useful in:

- * contracts
- * litigation documents
- * corporate agreements
- * affidavits
- * pleadings

Important learner distinction

> **Exhibit A in a trial**

> = 證物 A

> **Exhibit A attached to a contract**

> = 合約附件 A

Same legal noun, different function.

For strict core counting, both belong to the broader **formally identified legal material** branch.

11. **Exhibit A = strongest/example evidence for an argument (比喻固定表達) — 最明顯的例證 ; 頭號證據**

The legal labeling system developed an everyday figurative expression.

Practice 22

> “If you think the system is inefficient, this case is **Exhibit A**.”

「如果你認為這個制度效率低，這個案例就是最明顯的**例證**。」

Practice 23

> “He says he never procrastinates. **Exhibit A**: the unfinished report.”

「他說自己從不拖延。****頭號證據****：那份還沒完成的報告。」

****Exhibit A = 最能支持某個論點的明顯例子 / 主要證據****

American Heritage recognizes this informal example use, and Collins separately defines ****Exhibit A**** as the primary example/evidence supporting an argument. ([美國遺產詞典][1])

This is a fixed expression, ****not**** another core lexical meaning.

12. ****exhibit = public showing/show/display (名詞 , 一般) — 展示 ; 展出****

Beyond the museum-specific use, ****exhibit**** can also broadly mean a ****show, display, or presentation****.

Practice 24

> “The annual technology ****exhibit**** attracted thousands of visitors.”

「年度科技****展覽 / 展示活動****吸引了數千名參觀者。」

This overlaps heavily with #8.

American Heritage gives the broad noun sense “a public showing; an exhibition,” while Collins’ American dictionary gives “a show; display; presentation.” ([美國遺產詞典][1])

I would merge it with #8.

13. ****exhibit = administer a medicine (醫學舊義) — 給藥 ; 施用藥物****

This one needs careful handling because dictionaries differ in presentation.

Some dictionaries still record:

> ****exhibit a drug****

= administer a drug as a remedy.

Collins/Webster’s New World still lists this as a medical sense, while Dictionary.com explicitly labels it ****obsolete****. Historical dictionary evidence also shows that it is an old medical use. ([柯林斯字典API][7])

Historical example pattern

> “The medicine was exhibited to the patient.”

= 向病人**給藥**

But for our database:

Status: historical / obsolete / exclude from modern learner core

This is exactly the kind of branch the SOP says to discover during the audit but then filter out if it is archaic or no longer useful in modern general English.

So we **record that it exists**, but we should **not teach it as an ordinary modern meaning**.

Related form: **exhibitor**

An **exhibitor** is a person, organization, company, artist, etc. that displays something publicly.

Practice 25

> “More than 200 **exhibitors** attended the trade show.”

「超過二百個**參展商 / 參展者**參加了展覽會。」

Practice 26

> “Each **exhibitor** was given a separate booth.”

「每個**參展商**都獲分配一個獨立攤位。」

exhibitor = 參與展覽並展示作品、產品等的人或機構

Cambridge explicitly lists **exhibitor** as the person who publicly shows something they own or have made. ([劍橋詞典][8])

Related form: **exhibiter**

Exhibiter is also attested as an agent noun meaning someone who exhibits, but **exhibitor** is by far the normal modern form.

American Heritage lists both **exhibitor** and **exhibiter**. ([美國遺產詞典][1])

For the learner database:

* **exhibitor** → keep

* **exhibiter** → recognize, but low priority

Related form: **exhibitory**

Exhibitory means relating to exhibiting/displaying.

American Heritage and Collins record the form. ([美國遺產詞典][1])

It is uncommon and specialist.

Database status: valid but low priority.

Related form: **exhibition**

Exhibition is the main event/process noun:

> an art exhibition

> an exhibition of skill

> an exhibition match

It has its own polysemy network and should remain a separate entry rather than being treated as merely “noun form of exhibit.”

Related family: **exhibitionism / exhibitionist**

These are semantically related but sufficiently lexicalized to deserve independent treatment.

exhibitionism

Everyday:

> deliberately attention-seeking/showy behaviour

> **炫耀 ; 愛出風頭**

Clinical:

> a specialized psychological/sexual sense

exhibitionist

Everyday:

> someone who likes conspicuously displaying themselves or attracting attention

> **愛出風頭的人**

Clinical:

> a person associated with the specialist exhibitionism sense

These should be family extensions, not meanings of bare **exhibit**.

Important distinction: **exhibit vs exhibition**

exhibit

can mean:

* an individual displayed object

* in AmE, a whole exhibition

exhibition

normally means:

* the organized event/display as a whole

So in British English:

> art exhibition

is generally the expected phrase.

In American English:

> art exhibit

is also normal for the entire display. ([劍橋詞典][4])

Important distinction: **exhibit vs display**

display

is very broad.

It can mean almost any act or arrangement of showing something.

exhibit

often suggests:

- * deliberate presentation
- * inspection
- * public showing
- * demonstration of a recognizable quality

American Heritage's synonym discussion notes that **exhibit** suggests an open presentation inviting inspection. ([美國遺產詞典][9])

Important distinction: **exhibit vs show**

show

is the ordinary general word:

> show me your passport

exhibit

is more formal and often suggests deliberately presenting something for:

- * inspection
- * public viewing
- * evaluation
- * demonstration

> exhibit paintings
> exhibit symptoms
> exhibit evidence

So:

> "Show me your hand."

ordinary.

> “Exhibit your hand.”

usually unnatural unless a very formal/special context exists.

Important distinction: **exhibit vs demonstrate**

For qualities:

exhibit

= visibly show/manifest the quality

demonstrate

= show clearly, often as evidence of ability or truth

> exhibit patience

> demonstrate competence

There is considerable overlap.

Important distinction: **exhibit vs reveal**

reveal

means make something previously hidden or unknown become known.

exhibit

does not require prior concealment.

> reveal a secret

> exhibit confidence

Important distinction: **exhibit vs manifest**

These are especially close in scientific/formal contexts.

manifest

= show clearly through signs or effects

exhibit

= display or possess an observable quality/property

> manifest symptoms

> exhibit symptoms

Both work, but **exhibit** is extremely common in technical descriptions of observable characteristics.

Important distinction: **legal exhibit vs evidence**

This is important.

evidence

is the broad category of material/information used to help establish facts.

exhibit

is usually a particular item or document that has been formally identified, marked, attached, offered, or introduced in a legal proceeding.

Cornell notes that evidence may include testimony, documents, photographs, recordings, DNA results, tangible objects, etc.; an **exhibit** is a formally identified item/material within legal procedure. ([法律信息研究所][10])

So:

****all exhibits used as proof are evidence, but not all evidence is an exhibit.****

Testimony, for example, is evidence but ordinarily not an exhibit.

Important distinction: **legal exhibit vs attachment**

In everyday documentation:

attachment

= anything attached to a message/document

exhibit

= a formally designated supporting attachment, especially in legal documents

> email attachment

> Exhibit 2 to the Agreement

Exhibit carries a more formal documentary role.

Grammar note: **transitive** vs **intransitive**

Transitive

> “The museum exhibits paintings.”

exhibit + object

Intransitive

> “The artist exhibits internationally.”

No object.

That second structure is important and should not be lost.

Countability note

As a noun, **exhibit** is countable in all major modern senses:

> an exhibit

> three exhibits

Examples:

* a museum exhibit

* a dinosaur exhibit

* Exhibit A

* several legal exhibits

Capitalization note: **Exhibit A / Exhibit B**

When used as a formal legal/document label:

> **Exhibit A**

the label is normally capitalized.

When used generically:

> an exhibit

> several exhibits

lowercase.

The figurative expression also commonly appears as:

> **Exhibit A**

because it consciously imitates legal labeling.

Pronunciation note

exhibit

/ɪɡˈzɪbɪt/

The main stress falls on:

> **ZIB**

The noun and verb normally share the same stress pattern.

Family sweep

For the practical modern lexical family, I would retain:

* **exhibit**

* **exhibits**

* **exhibited**
 * **exhibiting**
 * **exhibitor**
 * **exhibition**

Recognize but lower-priority:

* **exhibiter**
 * **exhibitory**

Broader lexical relatives:

* **exhibitionism**
 * **exhibitionist**

Historical/obsolete branch discovered but excluded from core:

* **exhibit a medicine = administer it**

This follows the SOP principle of searching widely first, then filtering by modern usefulness rather than failing to discover the sense at all.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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exhibit — deliberately present to view	把某物呈現給別人觀看、檢查或注意
exhibit — publicly display	在博物館、畫廊、展覽會、比賽等公開展出某物
exhibit — intransitive	作為藝術家 / 參展者公開參展或展示作品
exhibit — quality/behaviour	顯示、表現出某種特質、情緒、行為或能力
exhibit — symptom/property	呈現某種可觀察的症狀、特徵、模式或性質
exhibit — legal verb	在法律程序中正式提交 / 出示文件、物件等
an exhibit — displayed object	博物館、畫廊等所展示的單件展品
an exhibit — whole show, especially AmE	一整個公開展覽 / 展出內容
exhibit — legal evidence	在法律程序中正式標記、提交或擬提交的證物 / 證據材料
exhibit — legal attachment	合約、訴狀、動議等法律文件正式附上的附件
Exhibit A — figurative	支持某個觀點的最明顯例子 / 主要例證
exhibit — medicine, historical	給藥、施藥；已過時，不納入現代核心
exhibitor	參展者 / 參展商
exhibition	展覽；另有自己的多義網絡

Recommended core database structure

After the exhaustive sweep, I would count **5** genuinely useful modern core meanings/branches for `exhibit` itself:

1. **verb** — deliberately/publicly show or display something

* includes museum, trade show, competition, inspection

* includes intransitive **artists exhibit**

2. **verb** — manifest/show a quality, behaviour, symptom, property, tendency, etc.

* includes scientific and medical descriptive use

3. **verb** — legal: formally submit/present evidence

* institutionalized legal meaning

4. **noun** — something publicly displayed

* a museum exhibit / individual exhibit

* with **whole exhibition/show** retained as an important especially-American extension

5. **noun** — formally identified legal material

* trial evidence

* documentary exhibit

* exhibit attached to a contract, motion, pleading, etc.

Keep separately as fixed expression:

> **Exhibit A = 最明顯的例證 / 頭號證據**

Keep as family extensions:

> **exhibitor, exhibition, exhibitionism, exhibitionist**

Deliberately exclude from the modern core:

> **exhibit = administer medicine**

because although historically genuine and still recorded by some dictionaries, at least one current dictionary explicitly labels it obsolete, and it is not useful ordinary modern English. ([字典][11])

This is the version I'd use to **replace all earlier `exhibit` notes**.

[1]: https://www.ahdictionary.com/word/search.html?q=exhibit&utm_source=chatgpt.com "American Heritage Dictionary Entry: exhibit"

[2]: https://dictionary.cambridge.org/us/dictionary/english/exhibit?utm_source=chatgpt.com "EXHIBIT | definition in the Cambridge English Dictionary"

[3]: https://dictionary.cambridge.org/us/dictionary/english/exhibiting?utm_source=chatgpt.com "EXHIBITING | definition in the Cambridge English Dictionary"

[4]: https://dictionary.cambridge.org/dictionary/english/exhibit?utm_source=chatgpt.com "EXHIBIT | English meaning - Cambridge Dictionary"

[5]: https://www.collinsdictionary.com/us/dictionary/english/exhibited?utm_source=chatgpt.com "EXHIBITED definition in American English | Collins English Dictionary"

[6]: https://www.law.cornell.edu/wex/exhibit?utm_source=chatgpt.com "exhibit | Wex | US Law | LII / Legal Information Institute"

[7]: https://api.collinsdictionary.com/dictionary/american/exhibit?utm_source=chatgpt.com "exhibit - definition of exhibit by HarperCollins"

[8]: https://dictionary.cambridge.org/dictionary/learner-english/exhibit?utm_source=chatgpt.com "EXHIBIT | meaning - Cambridge Learner's Dictionary"

[9]: https://ahdictionary.com/word/search.html?q=SHOW&utm_source=chatgpt.com "American Heritage Dictionary Entry: SHOW"

[10]: https://www.law.cornell.edu/wex/evidence?utm_source=chatgpt.com "evidence | Wex | US Law | LII / Legal Information Institute"

[11]: https://www.dictionary.com/browse/exhibit?utm_source=chatgpt.com "EXHIBIT Definition & Meaning | Dictionary.com"